

4. Project Planning Phase

•The Project Planning Phase focuses on organizing the activities, resources, responsibilities, and timeline required to complete the spreadsheet data-import project. Planning is important because it ensures that the project progresses systematically from configuration to testing and documentation.

The first activity is to divide the project into smaller tasks. These tasks may include preparing the spreadsheet, creating the source/import table, identifying the target table, creating the Transform Map, configuring field mappings, adding transformation rules, performing the import, testing the results, and preparing documentation.

A suitable schedule should be created for these activities. For example, the first stage can focus on requirements and spreadsheet preparation. The second stage can focus on designing the tables and Transform Map. The third stage can focus on configuration and development. The fourth stage can be used for testing and correcting errors. The final stage can be used for documentation and demonstration.

•Resources should also be identified. The project may require a ServiceNow development instance or another suitable environment that supports Import Sets and Transform Maps. A spreadsheet application may be required to prepare and edit the source file.

The project team should determine responsibilities. If the project is performed by a team, one person may prepare the spreadsheet, another may configure the Transform Map, and another may perform testing and documentation. In an individual academic project, the same person can perform all these activities.

Planning should also consider possible risks. Common risks include incorrect column names, missing mandatory values, duplicate records, incorrect data types, invalid references, and unexpected transformation results. A plan should be prepared for identifying and correcting these issues.

A sample project plan could include:

- 1.Activity
- 2.Purpose
- 3.Requirement analysis
- 4.Identify project requirements
- 5.Spreadsheet preparation
- 6.Create clean source data
- 7.Source table setup

8.Store imported spreadsheet records

9.Target analysis

10.Identify destination fields

11.Transform Map configuration

12.Define transformation process

13.Data mapping

14.Connect source and target fields

15.Testing

16.Verify imported records

17.Error correction

18.Resolve import problems

19.Documentation

20.Record the complete process

21.Demonstration

Present the working project

Planning also includes defining the expected deliverables. The final deliverables may include the prepared spreadsheet, configured Transform Map, successfully imported records, test results, screenshots, and project documentation.

Therefore, the planning phase provides a structured roadmap for completing the project within the available time and resources.